Oven carnitas

Roy Choi's whole pork shoulder, slow-roasted in its own fat for 5–6 hours

Serves 8 · **Prep** 15 min · **Cook** 6 h · **Rest** 20 min · Adapted from masterclass.com

A whole shoulder, salted hard and sealed tightly in a pot, cooks very low until it collapses under a spoon and sits in a pool of its own rendered fat. Keep that fat: it goes into the pork fat cilantro rice served underneath.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 boneless pork shoulder, about 2.3 kg (5 lb)
- 3 tbsp kosher salt or coarse sea salt
- 1½ tbsp freshly ground black pepper
- 4 garlic cloves, peeled
- 60 ml (¼ cup) neutral oil, such as canola or grapeseed

For serving

- 1 batch salsa verde (recipe)
- 3 red radishes, trimmed and quartered
- 4 lime wedges

METHOD

1. **Make the salsa verde.** Make the salsa verde and set it aside.
2. **Season the pork.** Heat the oven to 110 °C (225 °F). Sprinkle the shoulder generously with the salt and pepper on all sides, working it into the nooks and crannies. Stuff the garlic cloves into the crevices, then drizzle the oil evenly over the meat.
3. **Roast low and slow.** Put the shoulder in a Dutch oven or pot with a tight-fitting lid (or seal the pot with foil) and cover it tightly. Roast undisturbed for 5–6 hours, until the meat collapses easily under the weight of a spoon and a good amount of fat has rendered into the bottom of the pot. Make the rice while it roasts.
4. **Rest.** Take the pot out of the oven and let it stand, still covered, for 20 minutes before you open it. Spoon off 250 ml (1 cup) of the rendered fat for the rice.
5. **Plate.** Spread the rice over a large platter and top it with large chunks of carnitas, breaking the meat apart with a fork if needed. Spoon the remaining cilantro sauce from the rice around the edges and drizzle the salsa verde over that. Scatter over the reserved chopped cilantro and parsley, garnish with the radishes and lime wedges, and eat straight away.

NOTES

- Leftover pork and rice make burritos with the salsa verde, as in the bonus lesson of the same class.
- The cooled pork keeps for 3–4 days in the fridge, covered with some of its fat.